

Mary (Xinxue) Lu

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SUMMARY

Detail-oriented and results-driven Financial Analyst with 6+ years of experience in cost optimization, financial management, and reporting within cloud environments. Expert in leveraging programming tools (SQL, Python, Tableau, Excel) and cloud platforms (AWS, Azure, GCP) to drive significant cost reductions and enhance operational efficiency. Strong ability to deliver actionable insights and strategic recommendations in fast-paced, dynamic settings.

SKILLS

Technical Skills: SQL, Python, R, Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint)

Analytic Tools: Tableau, MySQL, QuickSight (AWS), Athena (AWS), Google Cloud Platform (GCP), SPSS/Eviews

Certification and Others: Certified Public Accountant (CPA), AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, A/B Testing, Jira

WORK EXPERIENCE

Financial Data Analyst *Cognizant US* *Foster City, CA* *Feb 2022 - Now*

- **Cloud Cost Optimization:** Achieved a **10% reduction** in cloud spending (over **\$5 million**) for Gilead Sciences by identifying inefficiencies using tools like **Compute Optimizer** and **Azure Advisor**. Proposed and implemented cost-saving solutions ranging from resource clean-ups, savings plans, and reserved instances to complex architectures such as serverless and application architecture improvement
- **Cloud Financial Management:** Analyzed and forecasted cloud expenditures, established budget control, and detected spending anomalies to meet budget goals. Managed purchase orders and invoices through the AWS/Azure billing console while ensuring chargeback accuracy by creating tagging strategies for over 600 accounts
- **Data Pipeline Development & Automation:** Built two automated ETL pipeline solutions to reduce manual reporting workload by 80% (Saved financial analyst 48 hours per month). One pipeline utilized AWS services (S3, Glue, Athena, and Quicksight). The other has combined AWS with Databricks, Starburst, and PowerBI to provide faster performance, security, cost savings, and an easy user interface with actionable insights for users

Business Analyst *China Zhongyuan Engineering Corp.* *Beijing, China* *Jul 2017 - Oct 2018*

- **Energy Data Analysis:** Led the analysis of energy consumption data across 3,000+ energy meters from 1,600+ buildings using machine learning models to identify trends and inefficiencies
- **Statistics and Predictive Modeling:** Performed statistical analysis, hypothesis testing, and a gradient boosting tree model to predict long-term and short-term energy consumption using Jupyter notebooks in Python and R

Data Analyst *Central University of Finance and Economics* *Beijing, China* *Jul 2013 - Jul 2015*

- **Salary Prediction & Equity Analysis:** Developed predictive models that helped increase female faculty salaries by 5% by analyzing historical data and implementing solutions using SQL, Excel VBA, and Tableau
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PROGRAM EXPERIENCES

Google Cloud Platform Project: Covid-19 Cases and Deaths Analysis in US States

- Developed an end-to-end data pipeline to ingest, transform, analyze, and visualize data with GCP services such as Dataflow, BigQuery, Compute Engine, Cloud Storage, Pub/Sub, and DataStudio
- Created Dataflow jobs to automatically read real-time data and visualize changes in cases and deaths

Machine Learning Project: Reddit Posts Classification and Analysis

- Deployed four machine learning models (Logistic Regression, Naive Bayes, KNN, and Random Forest) with Python (NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib, sci-kit-learn) to classify two sub-channels of Reddit with 0.81 accuracies
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EDUCATION BACKGROUND

M.S. Data Analytics *San José State University, California, US* *2020 - 2022*

M.S. Economics *Central University of Finance and Economics, Beijing, China* *2015 - 2017*

B.A. Economics *Central University of Finance and Economics, Beijing, China* *2009 - 2013*